According to Noise Pollution (Regulation and Control) Rules, 2000, the permissible limit of noise in areas categorized as commercial is 65 decibels (dB) during day and 55 dB during night.

12.5 Agrochemicals

Chemicals which are used in agriculture for growth of plants and pest control are called agrochemicals or agrichemicals.

Overuse of agrochemicals have been observed to generate residues that cause nutrient imbalance. In addition,

- May kill beneficial bacteria and soil organisms.
- Can cause eutrophication in water bodies.
- Affect aquatic animals and their productivity.
- Pesticide containing water, even in trace quantities is unfit for human consumption.
- Particles (aerosols) and residues of these chemicals cause air pollution.

1. Mosquito Repellents

DEET (n-n-diethylnetatoluamide) and allethrin used in mosquito coils may cause itching, burning, tingling sensation or numbness.

2. **Colony collapse syndrome** in Honey bees due to pesticides/herbicides can lead to destruction of hives and lower agricultural productivity. **!!Remember bees are Nature's best pollinators!!**



- Inhalation of contaminated air can cause respiratory problems.
- Consumption can lead to poisoning, side effects and after effects.
- Chemicals can cause skin rashes and irritation of eyes.
- Many of these chemicals are reported to be carcinogenic.
- They can trigger hormonal disorders and neurotoxicity.
- Beneficial insects and animals can be affected.

12.6 Biomagnification

Food chains are components of all ecosystems. Producers and consumers form trophic levels in a chain through which energy flow is carried out by the process of eating and being eaten. Usage, storage and transformation of food and biomolecules by metabolism are a normal process. Degradation or breakdown is an essential part of any food chain and hence all naturally occurring substances are degradable.

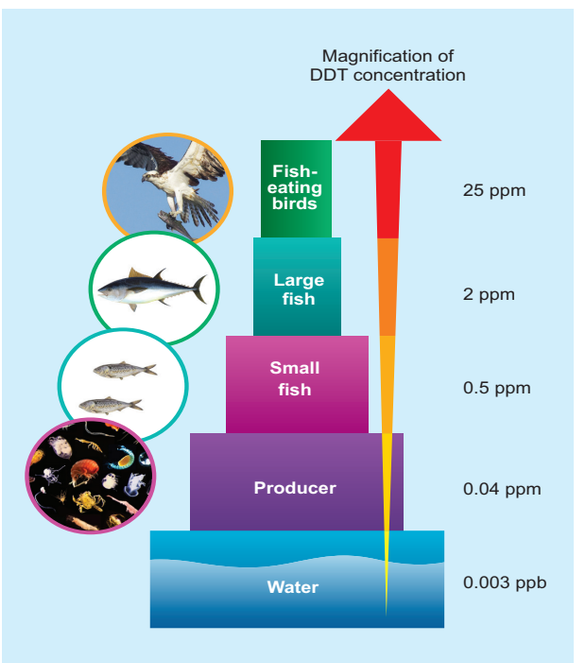


Fig. 12.4 Biomagnification

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